

The rise of Nilanka: empowering women through poultry farming

Introduction

In the village of Ethabandiwewa, Morawewa DSD, Trincomalee, resides Nilanka Pushpakumari- a woman of resilience, determination, and unwavering dedication to her family's well-being. Her journey from a housewife to a successful beneficiary of the JSB project is a testament to the transformative impact of opportunity and perseverance.

Seizing opportunity



In Sri Lanka's life took a significant turn when she became a recipient of the JSB project, an initiative generously funded by the Japanese government to uplift rural communities. With UNDP's technical expertise and Janathakshan's social mobilization efforts, the project aimed to empower women like Nilanka to achieve economic independence and self-sustainability. With three children to support and her husband serving as a civil security officer, Nilanka embraced this opportunity with hope and determination.

From struggle to success

Before the JSB project, Nilanka's family relied solely on her husband's monthly income, which amounted to 35,000 rupees. However, with the additional support from the project, they received an extra 15,000 rupees, significantly improving their financial stability. Nilanka was provided with 20 chicks and a coop, laying the foundation for her journey into poultry farming.

Nurturing growth

With meticulous care and dedication, Nilanka nurtured her fledgling poultry farm, leveraging her newfound resources to sustain and expand her business. She diligently reinvested the proceeds from selling eggs into purchasing quality feed for her chickens, ensuring their health and productivity. Through perseverance and hard work, her poultry farm began to thrive, supplementing her family's income and providing them with a source of stability and security.

Empowering women, enriching lives

Nilanka's success not only transformed her own life but also had a ripple effect within her community. As a role model for other women, she inspired them to embrace entrepreneurship and pursue their dreams fearlessly. Through her perseverance and determination, Nilanka shattered stereotypes and empowered women to break free from traditional gender roles, fostering a culture of self-reliance and empowerment in Ethabandiwewa Cascade.

Looking towards the future

As she looks towards the future, Nilanka is filled with optimism and ambition. With her poultry farm flourishing, she dreams of further expanding her business and diversifying her income streams. Through continuous dedication and hard work, she aims to achieve financial independence for her family and contribute to the prosperity of her community.

Conclusion

Nilanka Pushpakumari's journey from a humble homemaker to a successful poultry farmer is a testament to the transformative power of opportunity, perseverance, and community support. Through the JSB project, backed by the Japanese government, and with the guidance of UNDP and Janathakshan, she has not only transformed her own life but also become a beacon of hope for women in her village. As she continues to inspire and empower others, Nilanka exemplifies the resilience and tenacity of women everywhere, proving that with determination and support, anything is possible.